

Book I - The Sagent Creed

Part 2 - The Shaken Jar

Chapter 05 - The Shaken Jar

EP01 — The Shaken Jar

Series: Sagent Creed **Type:** Mythic Monologue **Core Concept:** Manufactured division — who is shaking the jar?

Source Material

From *The Sagent Creed: A Spiral Path Through Love, Truth, and the Force Within*:

"Picture a glass jar. Inside it live one hundred red ants and one hundred black ants... Then someone picks up the jar and shakes it. Violently. When the shaking finally stops, the red ants look around and see black ants. The black ants look around and see red ants. And each group arrives at the same furious, terrified, utterly reasonable-seeming conclusion: they did this. They are the enemy."

"The genius of the shaken jar, as a mechanism of control, is its self-sustaining quality... Each act of aggression between red and black ant confirms the original assumption: see, they really are dangerous. The violence that was a response to confusion becomes the evidence for more violence."

"The cruelest sophistication of the design is that it uses genuine suffering as its fuel."

Thesis

The most dangerous question an ant can ask is not "which side is right" — it's "who picked up the jar?"

Sovereignty of mind — each person thinking clearly — is the only answer. It cannot be handed down from above. It can only emerge when individuals think freely.

Hook:

"There are one hundred red ants and one hundred black ants. They have lived together long enough to know each other's faces. Then someone picks up the jar."

The Mechanism: Describe how manufactured division works. Real wounds. Real enemies. But the source of the wound is not what the wounded believe it to be.

The Self-Perpetuation: The ants who decide to fight the other side with maximum ferocity do not escape the jar. They become accomplices in the shaking.

The Turn: Sovereignty of mind. The ant who stops fighting and asks: who is shaking this jar? That ant represents a node of resistance the shaker cannot reach.

The Prestige:

"You cannot fight the hand that shakes the jar using the methods of the one who shakes it. You can only become so clear — so lit from within — that the dark has nowhere to live."

Visual Notes

- Glass jar with ants fighting (animated or stock footage of ants)
- Cut to: hands holding something, pulling strings, watching from behind glass
- Cut to: a single ant that stops — looks up — toward the glass
- Slow zoom out to reveal the jar in a hand, and the hand in a room, and the room in a world
- Final image: the jar is set down. The ants are still.

Source Quotes

Direct quotes from Sage's own writing to draw from when scripting this episode.

"There are 100 red ants and 100 black ants in a jar. The jar is shook and the red ants think black is the enemy and the black ants think red is the enemy. But the real enemy is the one who shook the jar. The only question is: how do you unshake the jar?"

"This story of the ants can be seen as a metaphor for conflict, where the red ants and black ants are caught up in fighting each other, but the true cause of the chaos is external, represented by the jar shaker."

"Provide clarity and understanding: After the shaking stops, it's important to help the ants — metaphorically, people — realize that their enemy isn't each other, but the external force that created the confusion. This involves fostering communication, awareness, and shared

understanding."

"Ultimately, to 'unshake the jar' is to restore peace by eliminating the external cause of confusion, allowing the red and black ants to realize they were never enemies in the first place."

"All agents have an enemy but a Sagent's enemy gains power through conflict. If you try to fight them of the world you will lose — you must fight them of the spirit."

"The greatest tool of the dark side of the force is the light side fighting it. Conflict fuels the dark side of the force and blinds the light. Compassion fuels the light side and brings light to the dark."

The Living Age Trilogy